

I've always enjoyed sharing my passion for couponing with anyone interested to learn, and in the current economy, interest in couponing remains high. People are looking to save money in every possible way, and when budgets are tight, coupons help families stretch their dollars in an easy, and often fun, way.

In the years I've been a serious couponer, I've seen many changes in the couponing world, changes that Mary discusses in *Coupon Crazy*. Paper coupons continue to top redemption rates among consumers each year, but print-at-home and electronic coupons continue to grow in popularity too. Additionally, online tools for couponers have exploded over the past decade. Grocery list "matchup" sites appeared online, tracking the lowest sale prices and matching coupons to sales. Then, between 2008 and 2010, coupon blogs exploded in popularity. Blogs offered localized deals and coupon instruction for beginners with step-by-step, easy-to-understand tips for chasing the sales and getting rock-bottom prices on everything from cereal to shampoo. To this day, thousands of bloggers around the country continue to share daily and weekly coupon deals with their readers.

In 2011, the TLC series *Extreme Couponing* thrust the concept of over-the-top coupon savings into the public eye on a weekly basis. Despite the show's often unrealistic portrayals of coupon usage, it piqued many people's interest in couponing, inspiring shoppers around the country to pick up a pair of scissors for the first time. Unfortunately, the show also featured extremists showing various ways to beat and cheat the system with coupons. Not content with the already-admirable savings that legitimate coupon use provided, some shoppers featured on the show even resorted to